



Australia Post Metro

Integration Specifications

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Australia Post

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Before you get started

Before you get started

The purpose of this document is to provide integration specifications for the Australia Post Metro service. The assumption is that you've already integrated to Lodgement V1 APIs with your existing eParcel contract services.

What is Metro?

Metro is a crosstown offer where parcels are picked up in either Adelaide, Brisbane, Melbourne, Perth and Sydney, then delivered the next day in the same city. Example: picked up in Melbourne and delivered next day in Melbourne.

This offer is only available to specific postcode ranges within the above cities. Pricing is not available outside of these postcode ranges (page 7), and an API call for deliveries outside these will result in an error message being presented (page 11).

What's staying the same?

Existing account numbers and MLIDs already configured with our shipping and tracking APIs can be used for Australia Post Metro.

Developer Centre will remain the same along with the endpoints needed to create shipments, create labels, get labels and create order - <https://developers.auspost.com.au/>

Current support engagement - <https://auspost.com.au/lodgement-techsupport/>

No changes to current tracking feeds or Track API - https://digitalapi.auspost.com.au/shipping/v1/track?tracking_ids={tracking_ids}

No changes to the manifest summary.

What's changing?

The label template is changing to align to a simplified label. This has benefits in the network with a larger data matrix barcode. *See the next page for details.*

What's out-of-scope for Metro?

Parcel Send – the Metro service is currently supported via Lodgement V1 API integration only.

Returns – your regular returns service must be utilised for returns.

Metro Product Details

Product Attributes

Sub product name	Metro		Metro with signature	
Product_ID (Charge Code)	3W03	3W33	3W05	3W35
Sub-Product	121		120	
Service Code	09 (no signature required)		45 (card if not home) 51 (receiver can request Safe Drop)	
Partial Consignment delivery allowed	Yes			
Cubing	Subject to cubing (Y-status)	Charged on dead weight (N-status)	Subject to cubing (Y-status)	Charged on dead weight (N-status)
Weight breaks	0—500g 501g—1kg 1.001—3kg 3.001—5kg 5.001—22kg is basic plus per kg			

Postcode Ranges

The postcode ranges for the Metro service are listed in a spreadsheet attached to this document. See how to access the spreadsheet below.

Please note: Pricing is not available outside of the below postcode ranges. This will result in any ‘Create Shipment’ API call to present an error for any postcode outside of the included postcode ranges (example on page 11). We recommend you maintain these postcode ranges in a way that only allows you to attempt to create Metro shipments for the included postcode ranges.

Please check your Pricing Schedule for details.

Access the postcode file:

1. In Adobe Reader, select the attachment icon to open the Attachment Pane
2. Open the Metro Postcodes .xlsx file
3. Postcodes for each state are in a separate tab
4. Column C represents the Metro Zone; the green cell indicates the locality is Metro. N/A indicates the locality is excluded from Metro.

1.

2.

Attachments

Name	Description
Metro Postcodes June 2024.xlsx	

3.

2026

HAVERTON NORTH

MEL

VIC

NSW

QLD

SA

WA

+

4.

	A	B	C	D
1	Postcode	Locality	Metro Zone	
512	3219	THOMSON	MEL	
513	3219	WHITTINGTON	MEL	
514	3220	GEE LONG	MEL	
515	3220	NEWTOWN	MEL	
516	3220	BAREENA	MEL	
517	3220	SOUTH GEE LONG	MEL	
518	3221	BARRABOOL	N/A	
519	3221	CERES	N/A	
520	3221	GNARWARRE	N/A	
521	3221	GEE LONG MC	N/A	

Please note: Metro service is only available between included postcode pairs within the same city, i.e., ADL to ADL, BNE to BNE, MEL to MEL, PER to PER and SYD to SYD.

Manifests, Shipments and Articles

Australia Post Metro Integration Requirements

A Manifest is a grouping of all consignments in each lodgement. Depending on the product and movement type, a Shipment (Consignment) can have one or more articles (items) in a parent-child relationship.

The maximum number of articles (items) in a “DESPATCH” movement type consignment is 20 (refer to support for more than 20 items).

Please note: all Metro parcels must be on a separate manifest and manifest summary report to the one containing your Parcel Post and Express Post parcels.

Merchant Location ID (MLID)

A Merchant Location ID (MLID) is a three or five alphanumeric value which represents an account/sub-account number linked to a specific lodgement point. Depending on your lodgement characteristics, Australia Post may provide you with multiple accounts (MLIDs).

If required, the same MLID used with Parcel Post and Express Post parcels can also be used with Metro parcels, otherwise, a new MLID can be provided.

Consignment Number

A consignment number is a MLID followed by seven digits. There are 10 million possible consignment numbers per MLID. When labels are generated, in-house management of consignment numbers is your responsibility. Australia Post systems require that each individual consignment number is used only once during a minimum period of two years and allocation of consignment numbers is expected to be in sequential order by MLID (account).

It is strongly recommended that you adhere to sequential order allocation by MLID when managing consignment numbers as this makes it easier for you to know what number is next in the sequence by just looking at the last number allocated and suppressing any risk of duplication.

Duplication of consignment numbers is a serious issue and will lead to data integrity issues, reporting inaccuracy, and/or charging errors for which Australia Post cannot be held responsible. Speak with your Australia Post representative for advice of an appropriate starting consignment number, particularly if the same account (MLID) is being used by various lodgement systems.

Delivery Point Identifier (DPID)

A DPID is an eight-digit number that represents a physical address and is obtained during address validation. You need to include a valid DPID within the barcode and electronic manifest data, so parcels can be deep sorted during automated parcel processing.

While not having the DPID in the barcode or manifest does not prevent you from lodging parcels, or the parcel being processed, Australia Post strongly recommends including the DPID within the label barcode to ensure a valid parcel delivery address.

You can find information about Address Matching Approval Systems (AMAS) at

<https://auspost.com.au/business-solutions/data-marketing-services/improve-your-data/address-data/address-validation>

JSON Payload example

The example on the following page shows a typical “Create Shipment” JSON payload; however, it is also applicable to the “Create Order including Shipments” API Create Shipment Payload.

Please note, row 34 contains the product ID 3W03 which is “Metro”. For “signature required” include 3W05.

```
1 {
2   "shipments":[
3     {
4       "shipment_reference":"XYZ-001-01",
5       "customer_reference_1":"Order 001",
6       "customer_reference_2":"SKU-1",
7       "email_tracking_enabled":true,
8       "from":{
9         "name":"John Citizen",
10        "lines":[
11          "1 Main Street"
12        ],
13        "suburb":"MELBOURNE",
14        "state":"VIC",
15        "postcode":"3000",
16        "phone":"0401234567",
17        "email":"john.citizen@citizen.com"
18      },
19      "to":{
20        "name":"Jane Smith",
21        "business_name":"Smith Pty Ltd",
22        "lines":[
23          "123 Centre Road"
24        ],
25        "suburb":"Sydney",
26        "state":"NSW",
27        "postcode":"2000",
28        "phone":"0412345678",
29        "email":"jane.smith@smith.com"
30      },
31      "items":[
32        {
33          "item_reference":"SKU-1",
34          "product_id":"3W03",
35          "length":"10",
36          "height":"10",
37          "width":"10",
38          "weight":"1",
39          "authority_to_leave":true,
40          "safe_drop_enabled":true,
41          "allow_partial_delivery":true,
42          "features":{
43            "TRANSIT_COVER":{
44              "attributes":{
45                "cover_amount":1000
46              }
47            }
48          }
49        },
50        "tracking_details":{
51          "consignment_id":"111JD0000120",
52          "article_id":"111JD000012001001210905",
53          "barcode_id":"01993128509999891111JD000012001001210905|4202000|8008211207140000"
54        }
55      ],
56    }
57  ]
58 }
```

Error code for invalid lodgement and destination postcode pairings

The two examples below show the error codes returned via the 'Create Shipment' API call when pairing invalid lodgement and destination postcodes.

Example A – the destination is outside the included postcode ranges (page 7).

```
1 {
2   "errors": [
3     {
4       "code": "42012",
5       "name": "PRODUCT_NOT_SUPPORTED_BY_CONTRACT_ERROR",
6       "message": "The product 3W05 you have entered is not available on your contract 0006616659 from lodgement 2000 to the destination 2251.
7 For further assistance please contact your Australia Post Account Manager or visit auspost.com.au/help-and-support",
8       "field": "shipments[0].items[0]",
9       "context": {
10        "product_id": "3W05",
11        "shipment_internal_ref": "shipments[0]",
12        "item_internal_ref": "shipments[0].items[0]",
13        "from": "2000",
14        "to": "2251",
15        "location_id": "0006616659"
16      }
17    }
18  ]
19 }
```

Example B – the lodgement and destination postcodes are in different cities.

```
1 {
2   "errors": [
3     {
4       "code": "42012",
5       "name": "PRODUCT_NOT_SUPPORTED_BY_CONTRACT_ERROR",
6       "message": "The product 3W05 you have entered is not available on your contract 0006616659 from lodgement 2000 to the destination 4000.
7 For further assistance please contact your Australia Post Account Manager or visit auspost.com.au/help-and-support",
8       "field": "shipments[0].items[0]",
9       "context": {
10        "product_id": "3W05",
11        "shipment_internal_ref": "shipments[0]",
12        "item_internal_ref": "shipments[0].items[0]",
13        "from": "2000",
14        "to": "4000",
15        "location_id": "0006616659"
16      }
17    }
18  ]
19 }
```

Label Specifications

Australia post uses automated parcel processing in both our parcel processing facilities and with our handheld delivery scanners. Automated parcel processing is dependent on parcel labelling and barcoding as well as accuracy and timeliness of electronic Order (manifest) data.

To ensure parcels are processed quickly and efficiently, labels and barcodes need to be formatted correctly. This section provides an overview of the contents and correct formatting of Australia Post labels and barcodes.

Assumed Knowledge

The following concepts are assumed knowledge:

- GS1 numbering and symbology (2D GS1 Data matrix barcode and GS1 128 linear barcode)
- Technology that helps and supports building those barcodes.
- Refer to page 20—37 for barcode specifications and guidance.

Australia Post Metro Integration Requirements

To take advantage of the Metro service, you will need to:

- Have a validated integration to Lodgement V1 APIs with eParcel contract services.
- Produce Metro barcoded labels and get these tested and approved by Australia Post.
- Have all labels and corresponding electronic data (Orders/manifests) produced by your systems tested and approved by Australia Post before use. You can access this testing service by contacting our [Lodgement Tech Support](#) team. We will ask you to complete and an “Integration Validation Form” as part of the process.

To finalise your integration, you need to:

- source the Manifest Summary from the Shipping & Tracking APIs or...
- produce a hard copy manifest (Order Summary) and get it approved by Australia Post. (visit the Australia Post Developer Centre for more information at <https://developers.auspost.com.au/>).

If you don't already you will be issued with production credentials after we approve all the aforementioned items.

Please contact [Lodgement Tech Support](#) for details.

Label design

Australia Post reserves the right to make changes to the label format. In the event this occurs, you'll be given ample notification to ensure you have time to make necessary changes and have the most current and compliant labels.

Label Format and Design

Example of a Metro label



Australia Post

M2M

To
Test Recipient
Your Business Pty Ltd
111 Bourke St
Address line 2
Address line 3
MELBOURNE VIC 3000



Ph: 03 1234 5678

Article
1 of 1

AU VIC 3000

Packaging
N/A

Consignment No: JDQ0222865

Weight Cubic weight
2.00kg N/A

From
Test Sender
Your Business Pty Ltd
111 Bourke St
Address line
MELBOURNE VIC 3000

References
Sender Reference 1
Sender Reference 2

Aviation Security and Dangerous Goods Declaration

The sender acknowledges that this article may be carried by air and will be subject to aviation security and clearing procedures; and the sender declares that the article does not contain any dangerous or prohibited goods, explosive or incendiary devices.
A false declaration is a criminal offence.

Article ID: 1234567890123455

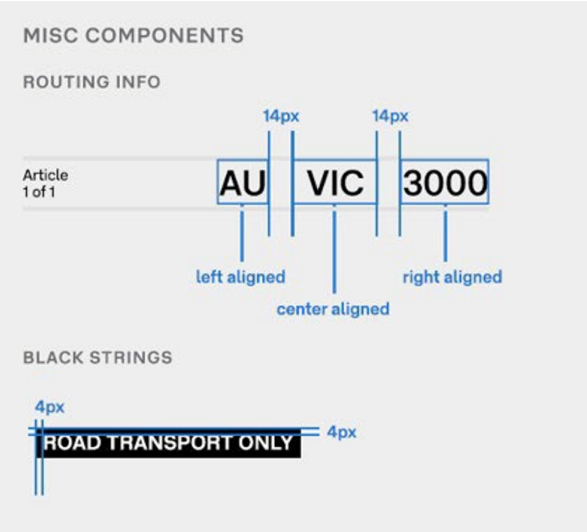
0528



Label Outline – negative space

10px		10px	
OUTLINE - NEGATIVE SPACE			
			
To Test Recipient Your Business Pty Ltd 111 Bourke St Address line 2 Address line 3 MELBOURNE VIC 3000			
		Ph: +613 1234 5678901234	
Article 1 of 1		AU VIC 3000	
Packaging N/A		Consignment No: JBQ0222865	
Weight 24.00kg		Cubic weight 28.00kg	
From Test Sender Your Business Pty Ltd 111 Bourke St Address line MELBOURNE VIC 3000		Recipient Sender reference 1 Sender reference 2	
Return to Sender and Dangerous Goods Declaration The sender acknowledges that this article may be carried by air and will be subject to aviation security and clearing procedures; and the sender declares that this article does not contain any dangerous or prohibited goods, explosives or incendiary devices. & other contents are not prohibited.			
Article ID: 0234567890123456		0234	
			
		10px	

Label Section dimensions & miscellaneous components



Label Data Map

Ref	Label area
1	Hero brand
2	Speed brand
3	“To” address block
4	GS1 2D Data Matrix
5	Phone number
6	Article number
7	Routing information
8	Receiver postcode
9	Consignment number
10	Declared weight
11	“From” address block
12	Sender references
13	Special area (reserved for DG declaration)
14a	GS1 Linear barcode
14b	Article ID
15	Date (mmdd)

1

Australia Post

2

M2M

3

To
Test Sender
Your Business Pty Ltd
111 Bourke St
Address line 2
Address line 3
MELBOURNE VIC 3000

4



5

Ph: 03 1234 5678

6

Article
1 of 1

7

AU VIC

8

3000

9

Consignment No: JDQ0222865

10

Weight Cubic weight
2.00kg N/A

11

From
Test Sender
Your Business Pty Ltd
123 Smith St
Address line
FITZROY VIC 3065

12

References
Sender Reference 1
Sender Reference 2

13

Aviation Security and Dangerous Goods Declaration
The sender acknowledges that this article contains dangerous goods in exempted quantities in accordance with the ADG code for road and rail transport.

14a

14b Article ID: 123456789012455



15

0528

Label Data Rules

Business rule	Label Area	Area Title	Details	Arial Font size	Requirement
Entire label	n/a	n/a	White label with black font, except those data items where white on black font is required. No colour background on any part of the label	various	Mandatory
Application of label	n/a	n/a	Label must be applied to one flat surface of the parcel and not wrapped over onto another surface.	n/a	Mandatory
Label format and layout (template)	n/a	n/a	Label examples and layout is provided in pages 12–15 of this document. Where a merchant seeks to modify this design in any way, a review and approval process must be undertaken.	n/a	Highly desirable
Hero Brand	1	n/a	Hero brand is the Black on White Australia Post brand	n/a	Mandatory
Article ID	14b	AP Article ID:	The article ID contains: • MLID • Sequence number • Article count • Sub-Product ID • Delivery Service code • Postage Paid attribute • Check digit	7	Mandatory
ConsignmentId	9	Consignment No:	Consignment number assigned by merchant when creating shipment.	8	Mandatory
Total Articles	6	Article n of n	Total number of articles in a shipment/consignment. If there are 3 articles in a consignment, the display text will be: Parcel n of 3, where n = 1, 2 or 3. A single article consignment display text will be Parcel 1 of 1.	8	Mandatory
Sender Ref block	12	References	2 x 50 characters sender references must be displayed if input for this article	8	Conditional
Deliver to Address Block	3	To	Name, Business name, Address lines, suburb, state, postcode must be formatted as one single block of text, left justified, using same font and must not be bold or italics - Arial 12 is recommended. The address information must not be truncated. Optical character recognition requires the location, state and postcode to be on one line and formatted as per the example below. The keyword "To:" must be provided and no line spaces may be included in the block. Commas must not be used. To: Mr individual Business name Receiver Unit 14 111 Bourke Street MELBOURNE VIC 3000	10 (regular)	Mandatory
Deliver to Name	3	n/a	Deliver to name	10	Mandatory
Deliver to Business Name	3	n/a	Business name	10	Optional
Deliver to address line	3	n/a		10	Mandatory

Business rule	Label Area	Area Title	Details	Arial Font size	Requirement
Deliver to Suburb	3	n/a	Must be upper case, separated by a space and on same line as State and postcode	10	Mandatory
Deliver to State	3	n/a	Must be upper case, separated by a space and on same line as Suburb and Postcode	10	Mandatory
Deliver to Postcode	3	n/a		10	
Weight dimension	10	Weight	Declared weight	10 (bold)	Mandatory
Cubic weight	10	Cubic weight	In Kg parcel dimensions in metres multiplied by each other and by conversion factor (Length x Width x Height) x 250	10 (bold)	Optional
DG Declaration (Dangerous, road only)	13	n/a	contains_dangerous_goods = true AND transportable_by_air = false “Aviation Security and Dangerous Goods Declaration The sender acknowledges that this article contains dangerous goods in exempted quantities in accordance with the ADG code for road and rail transport.”	7	Mandatory
DG Declaration (not dangerous)	13	n/a	contains_dangerous_goods = false “Aviation Security and Dangerous Goods Declaration The sender acknowledges that this article may be carried by air and will be subject to aviation security and clearing procedures; and the sender declares that the article does not contain any dangerous or prohibited goods, explosive or incendiary devices. A false declaration is a criminal offence.”	7	Mandatory
Deliver to Phone	5	Ph:	Must be located in this position if provided	8	Optional
Sender address block	11	From	Formatted block of text which comprises, Sender Address line, suburb, state, postcode fields below. Used if parcel is returned to sender.	8	Mandatory
Sender Name	11	n/a	Sender Name	8	Mandatory
Sender Address Line	11	n/a	Sender Address line	8	Mandatory
Sender Suburb	11	n/a	Sender Suburb (upper case)	8	Mandatory
Sender State	11	n/a	Sender State (upper case) Valid values (NSW VIC QLD SA TAS WA NT ACT)	8	Mandatory
Sender Postcode	11	n/a	Sender block Postcode	8	Mandatory
Routing details – Destination country code	7	n/a	Destination country code for domestic parcels is AU, must be UPPERCASE and centred horizontally and vertically.	22 (bold)	Mandatory
Routing details – Destination state	7	n/a	Must be UPPERCASE and centred horizontally and vertically.	22 (bold)	Mandatory
Postcode	8	n/a	Must be largest visually font on label and very clear and centred horizontally and vertically	22 (bold)	Mandatory
Date	15	n/a	The lodgement data is the date label was produced. (mmdd)	6	Mandatory

Barcode Specifications

Australia Post Metro Barcodes

Australia Post barcodes comply with GS1 standards. Two barcodes are required on domestic parcels to ensure Australia Post can process, deliver, and assure parcel services.

1. **Linear GS1-128 barcode**

Used for article tracking on devices unable to scan a 2D data matrix barcode and containing:

- Australia Post GTIN
- Article Tracking Reference

2. **Two-dimensional GS1 Data Matrix barcode**

Used for Article Tracking and containing the same information as the GS1 Linear Barcode above but also including additional components:

- Australia Post GTIN
- Article Tracking Reference
- Postcode
- Delivery Point Identification Number (DPID)
- Barcode Production Date/Time

The Australia Post Parcel Contract GS1-128 Linear Barcode

- Barcode width: 83.8mm (3 characters MLIDs) or 89.4mm (5 characters MLIDs).
- Barcode Height: Recommended 22mm (16 mm minimum).
- Human readable: Arial 8 to 10. Characters in the human readable line logically arranged, article number preceded by the text "AP Article ID:".
- Light Margin: 2.54 mm minimum at each side.

Example of a domestic Parcel Post GS1-128 barcode.

Full data string:

<F1>01993126509999989111JDQ100001201002050908

AP Article Id: 11JDQ100001201002050908



Each alpha or numeric character in a GS1 128 barcode is represented by a combination of 11 dark and light modules, arranged in different number sets, known as A, B, and C.

In the linear barcode we use character sets A and C.

Set A

Set A encodes one character per module and includes all the standard upper-case alpha and numeric characters, plus control and special characters. We use this character set to encode the Merchant Location Id, which often contains alpha characters.

Note: It is fine to use set B instead of set A, as long as any alpha characters are kept in upper case. Some commercially available barcode production software will use character set B in place of character set A, which is acceptable, if capitals are always used.

Set C

Set C is for numeric characters (digits) only and includes the set of 100-digit pairs from 00 through 99, as well as three special characters. Set C is the most efficient as it encodes data at twice the density of set A, so therefore represents two digits in one symbol character.

The barcode uses the following auxiliary characters:

- start C
- code A
- code C
- FNC1
- Stop

The start character in the barcode is always Start C, as it always begins with the set C (numeric characters).

Code A and C characters allow a change in character set to be made within the barcode. All characters following the code character are encoded according to the corresponding character set until another code character appears.

The following characters are then encoded according to the latest code character. Code A changes the encoding to set A and code C changes it back to set C.

Table 2: Component descriptions of domestic Australia Post Parcel Contract GS1-128 Linear Barcode.

Description	No. of characters*	Detail
Start C character		
Function 1 Symbol Character		FNC1 (Codeword ASCII value of 232)
Application Identifier	2	01
Indicator	1	9
Company Prefix	7	9312650
Item Reference	5	99999
Check Digit	1	8
Application Identifier	2	91
Code A character		
Merchant Location ID	3 or 5*	The identifier provided by Australia Post will uniquely identify Lodgement locations and merchants may use multiple location IDs.
Code C character		
Consignment ID	7	ID is provided by the merchant. Allows a possible 9,999,999 cons. per Merchant Location before reuse of numbers is required. Numbers must not be reused within a 2-year period.
Article Count	2	Position of the article in the consignment (e.g., 01 is the first, 02 the second etc. up to 20).
Product Code	5	Refer to page 6.
Service Code	2	Defines delivery actions required e.g. signature on delivery. Refer to page 6.
Postage Paid character	1	*0* for Parcel contract customers
Check Digit	1	Used to verify the validity of the eye- readable Article ID
Symbol check character		Used to validate the barcode quality
Stop character		

GS1 Data Matrix Symbol

The GS1 DataMatrix Quiet Zone is one module wide on all four sides. As with other bar code Quiet Zones, do not print in this area.

The data is encoded using a series of dark or light dots based upon a pre-determined size. The minimum size of these dots is known as the X-dimension. The recommended size of the Data Matrix Symbol is 13.68 x 13.68mm.

The data is then encoded in a matrix within the Finder pattern. This is a translation into the binary Data Matrix symbology characters (numeric or alphanumeric).

For GS1 System compatibility, FNC1 shall be encoded at the beginning of the data string and should be used as a group separator. When a FNC1 is used as a group separator, it shall be represented in the transmitted message by the ASCII character <GS> (ASCII value 29).

The characteristics of the GS1 DataMatrix include:

- The figure below represents a GS1 DataMatrix Symbol with 26 rows and 26 columns (including the perimeter finder pattern but not including Quiet Zones).
- Data Matrix is a matrix (2D or two-dimensional) bar code which may be printed as a square or rectangular symbol made up of individual dots or squares. For eParcel GS1 DataMatrix, only square symbols should be used.
- The GS1 DataMatrix solid "L" shaped finder or alignment pattern is one module wide. It is primarily used to determine the size, orientation, and distortion of the symbol.
- The other two sides of the finder pattern are alternating light and dark elements, known as the "Clock Track". This defines the basic structure of the symbol and can also help determine its size and distortion.

Full string:

<F1>019931265099999891JDQ000126101002003506<F1>4203000<F1>9247609364<F1>
>8008220414002938

Figure 10: Example of a domestic Australia Post Parcel Contract GS1 Data Matrix symbol.



Component descriptions of Australia Post Parcel Contract GS1 Data Matrix

Description	No. of characters*	Detail
Start C character		
Function 1 Symbol Character		FNC1 (Codeword ASCII value of 232)
Application Identifier	2	01
Indicator	1	9
Company Prefix	7	9312650
Item Reference	5	99999
Check Digit	1	8
Application Identifier	2	01
Code A character		
Merchant Location ID	3 or 5*	The identifier provided by Australia Post will uniquely identify Lodgement locations and merchants may use multiple location IDs.
Code C character		
Consignment ID suffix	7	ID is provided by the merchant. Allows a possible 9,999,999 cons. per Merchant Location before reuse of numbers is required. Numbers must not be reused within a 2-year period.
Article Count	2	Position of the article in the consignment (e.g. 01 is the first, 02 the second etc. up to 20).
Product Code	5	Refer to page 6.
Service Code	2	Defines delivery actions required e.g. signature on delivery. Refer to page 6.
Postage Paid character	1	*0* for Parcel contract customers
Check Digit	1	Used to verify the validity of the eye- readable Article ID
Symbol check character		Used to validate the barcode quality
Stop character		

Table continued next page

Description	No. of characters*	Detail
Function 1 Symbol Character	1	Group Separator – FNC1 (Codeword ASCII value of 232)
Application Identifier	3	420 (always)
Postcode	4	Delivery Postcode
Function 1 Symbol Character	1	Group Separator - FNC1 (Codeword ASCII value of 232) - Remove from the barcode string if DPID is not available.
Application Identifier	2	92 (Remove from the barcode string if DPID is not available)
Delivery Point Identifier (DPID)	8	An 8-digit reference which indicates the physical address of the consignment delivery - see Delivery Point Identifier (DPID) Provisioning. Remove from the barcode string if DPID is not available.
Function 1 Symbol Character	1	Group Separator - FNC1 (Codeword ASCII value of 232)
Application Identifier	4	8008
Date and Time of label generation	12	YYMMDDHHMMSS

The Australia Post Parcel Contract Check Digit

The check digit is the last digit of the article number, and it is there to ensure the validity of the article number.

For the barcode, the EAN/UCC-13 check digit algorithm is used to produce a human readable check digit which ensures that when the eye-readable line is entered manually, a check is made on the accuracy of data entry.

All characters in the barcodes are numeric except for the Merchant Location ID (MLID) which could be alphanumeric, care should be taken to ensure that your check digit algorithm can accommodate both types of MLIDs.

Prior to the calculation, any alpha character in the barcode needs to be replaced by the second digit of the equivalent value in the ASCII character set.

Table 5: Reference table for converting alpha characters into digits.

Character	ASCII code	Character	ASCII code
A	65	N	78
B	66	O	79
C	67	P	80
D	68	Q	81
E	69	R	82
F	70	S	83
G	71	T	84
H	72	U	85
I	73	V	86
J	74	W	87
K	75	X	88
L	76	Y	89
M	77	Z	90

Note that article numbers can be either 21 or 23 characters long (depending on if the MLID is 3 or 5 characters), the A.P. Article ID or Article Number is displayed in human readable format, for calculation of the check digit the first 20 (3 characters MLID) or 22 (5 characters MLID) characters of the human readable are considered.

Example 1

The following is an example of a check digit calculation procedure for a GS1-128 barcode with a 3 characters MLID (DJS) 019931265099999891DJS123456701002010902. The first 20 characters of the human readable part of the barcode is highlighted.

Step 1: Replace all alpha characters with the last digit of the ASCII representation as per Table 9.
84312345670100201090

Step 2: Starting with the first number on the right, add all alternate numbers. Multiply the result by three 84312345670100201090 so $(4 + 1 + 3 + 5 + 7 + 1 + 0 + 0 + 0 + 0) * 3 = 63$

Step 3: Starting with the second number on the right, add all the alternate numbers.
84312345670100201090 so $8 + 3 + 2 + 4 + 6 + 0 + 0 + 2 + 1 + 9 = 35$

Step 4: Add the results of Step 2 and Step 3 Total = 98

Step 5: Add the number needed to bring the total to the next multiple of ten. In this case it is 2, which is the check digit.

Note if a result is divisible by 10, then the check digit is 0.

Example 2

Now let's do one calculation for a 5 characters MLID (1JDQ1) to ensure that we are always getting the calculation right - 0199312650999998911JDQ1200000101002024502

Step 1: Replace all alpha characters with the last digit of the ASCII representation as per Table 9.
1481120000010100202450

Step 2: Starting with the first number on the right, add all alternate numbers. Multiply the result by three 1481120000010100202450 so $4 + 1 + 2 + 0 + 0 + 1 + 1 + 0 + 0 + 4 + 0 = 13 \times 3 = 39$

Step 3: Starting with the second number on the right, add all the alternate numbers.
1481120000010100202450 so $1 + 8 + 1 + 0 + 0 + 0 + 0 + 0 + 2 + 2 + 5 = 19$

Step 4: Add the results of Step 2 and Step 3 Total = 58

Step 5: Add the number needed to bring the total to the next multiple of ten. In this case it is 2, which is the check digit.

Note if a result is divisible by 10, then the check digit is 0.

Sample code of check digit algorithm (VBA)

```
Private Function CheckDigit(MyArticleNumber) Do Until  
I = Len(MyArticleNumber)  
MyDigit = IIf(Asc(Mid(MyArticleNumber, Len(MyArticleNumber) - i, 1)) > 47 And  
Asc(Mid(MyArticleNumber, Len(MyArticleNumber) - i, 1)) < 58, Mid(MyArticleNumber,  
Len(MyArticleNumber) - i, 1), Right(Trim(Str(Asc(Mid(MyArticleNumber,  
Len(MyArticleNumber) - i, 1)))), 1))  
Mynumber = Mynumber + IIf(i Mod 2 = 0, 3 * (Val(MyDigit)), (Val(MyDigit))) i = i +  
1 Loop  
CheckDigit = (Right(Str(10000 - Mynumber), 1)) End Function
```

Symbol Check Character

The symbol check character allows a quality check of the whole barcode, it is modulo 103 and it appears immediately before the stop character in the barcode.

It is not to be confused with the Australia Post Parcel Contract Check digit which is used to validate the article number (data). They are two different things, unless you are writing software to assemble a barcode from scratch, you do not need to know about the Symbol.

The Symbol Check character is automatically added by the barcode generation library or software in use.

Options for label printing

Shipping & Tracking APIs

We recommend using our Create Label API for the following reasons:

- Developers are not required to acquire knowledge about barcodes and label formats as these are obtained by JSON messaging.
- It eliminates the need for changes to label formats to align to Post requirements when new products, services and features are added to the merchant's contract.
- The Shipping & Tracking APIs can manage the allocation of consignment and article numbers preventing duplication.
- The Shipping & Tracking APIs perform address validation (adds DPID) for successful delivery.
- The Shipping & Tracking APIs perform validation against the merchant contract and only allows printing of labels for products, services and features included in the merchant contract, it allows matching of electronic data

Note: further information about the Shipping and Tracking APIs is available at <https://developers.auspost.com.au/>

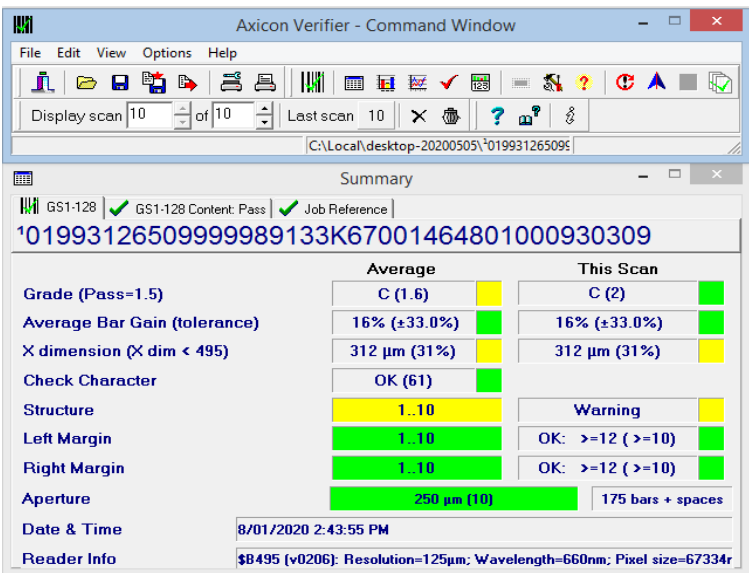
Label and Barcode Testing

Before using labels and barcodes produced using non-Australia Post systems, the following testing process must be followed:

- a series of labels must be produced with various combinations of products, services, and features to demonstrate the ability to calculate the check digit and deal with different sizes of consignments
- these labels must be forwarded to your Lodgement & APIs Consultant, who will perform a quality test and ensure they conform to Australia Post’s standards and can be read by Australia Post’s scanners
- a live test on the automatic sorter must be performed to confirm whether labels are suitable for automated sorting.

Only after approving all assets associated with your integration, will we provide approval to produce labels in the production environment.

Figure 11 – Testing for quality with the barcode Verifier

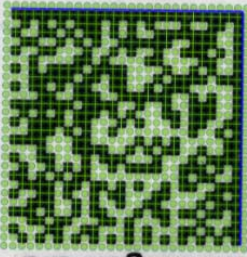


We use Axicon verifier equipment for quality checks on both the linear barcode and the 2D Datamatrix symbol.

This equipment allows us to determine if barcodes are GS1 compliant and are suitable for automated processing.

In the example the barcode is well formed, and has passed the quality test, note the grade average (1.6) just above the minimum for the industry standard (1.5). This causes for the

The GS1 2D Datamatrix barcode tested below is both, GS1 and AP compliant



Overall Symbol Grade
A (4.0)
4.0/20/660

GS1 Format Grade
PASS

Symbology
GS1 DataMatrix

Go Live

GS1 Acceptance Criteria
PASS

Data

<F1>0199312650999998911J0Q1200000101000930300<F1>4202190<F1>8008170417202449<F1>0199312650999998911J0Q1200000101000930300<F1>4202190<F1>8008170417202449

Webcam TruCheck™ USB Verification Report

Software Version: 3.03.15, Unit Serial: TC-875-0514-610
Verified: Tue 18-Apr-2017 02:02:36 PM, Last Calibrated: Thu 16-Apr-2015 10:42:50 AM
Page 1 of 3

Report Summary

GS1 Acceptance Criteria **PASS**

GS1 Acceptance Criteria **PASS**

Data

Symbology

GS1 DataMatrix

Verifications Grades

Standard	Grade	Aperture	Wavelength	Lighting	Format Grade
ISO 15415	A (4.0)	20	660	45	4.0/20/660
Auto-Comp	A (4.0)	20	660	45	4.0/20/660

Lighting: 45

Image

Postage Paid

ISO15415 Quality Parameters

Item	Value	Unit	Grade
1. Overall Error Correction (ECC)	100%	%	PASS
2. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
3. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
4. Area Variance (AV)	2%	%	PASS
5. Area Variance (AV)	2%	%	PASS
6. Area Variance (AV)	2%	%	PASS
7. Line Pattern (LP)	4.0	A	PASS
8. Line Pattern (LP)	4.0	A	PASS
9. Line Pattern (LP)	4.0	A	PASS
10. Line Pattern (LP)	4.0	A	PASS
11. Line Pattern (LP)	4.0	A	PASS
12. Line Pattern (LP)	4.0	A	PASS
13. Line Pattern (LP)	4.0	A	PASS
14. Line Pattern (LP)	4.0	A	PASS
15. Line Pattern (LP)	4.0	A	PASS
16. Line Pattern (LP)	4.0	A	PASS
17. Line Pattern (LP)	4.0	A	PASS
18. Line Pattern (LP)	4.0	A	PASS
19. Line Pattern (LP)	4.0	A	PASS
20. Line Pattern (LP)	4.0	A	PASS

General Characteristics

Item	Value	Unit	Grade
1. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
2. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
3. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
4. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
5. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
6. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
7. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
8. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
9. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
10. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
11. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
12. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
13. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
14. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
15. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
16. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
17. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
18. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
19. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
20. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS

Data Format Check

GS1 DataMatrix **PASS**

Item	Value	Unit	Grade
1. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
2. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
3. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
4. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
5. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
6. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
7. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
8. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
9. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
10. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
11. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
12. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
13. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
14. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
15. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
16. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
17. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
18. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
19. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS
20. Symbol Contrast (SC)	94%	%	PASS

Preliminary “In house” barcode testing

To speed-up barcoded label development and code debugging, it is recommended you and your developers use barcode testing tools and apps available online. The NEOREADER app for example can be downloaded free of charge for use at <http://www.neoreader.com/>

Here is an example of the correct readings:

2D Datamatrix barcode - this reading was obtained from scanning the 2D barcode in figure 6 of this document with the NEOREADER app.

Check out what I just scanned with NeoReader

Check out what I just scanned with NeoReader:
"jd2019931265099999891JDQ01945710100093030842021908008170417155407"

To start scanning barcodes with your mobile phone, check out <http://www.neoreader.com> or download NeoReader from your app store.

Note "jd2" at the start of the string, it is an indication that the FNC1 character is present.
Note also the diagonal line within a square just before application identifiers "420" and "8008", it indicates that the FNC1 is present as separator character.
By the way in this case DPID could not be determined hence why AI "92" and its corresponding FNC1 representation were not included in the barcode string.

With NEOREADER you should email the results to yourself as often the square symbols are only visible when opening the email attachment.

You should also be aware that “jd2” is a standard representation of the Function1 character when the GS1 2D Datamatrix is read by scanning devices (including the NEOREADER app). This does not mean the “jd2” is to be inserted as text in the barcode string. The same applies to those Function 1 characters acting as AI separators.

Depending on the library or technique being used, to achieve a Function1 character, you need to check the documentation or contact the providers of your barcode tool for advice.

Example of an emailed output from NeoReader.

Check out what I just scanned with NeoReader:
"jd2019931265099999891JDQ019435001000930200420084192884331128008170329183448"

GS1 128 Linear barcode

This reading was obtained from scanning the linear barcode in figure 5 of this document with the NEOREADER app.

]C1019931265099999891JDQ019457101000930308

Note the "]C1" in the linear barcode indicates that a FNC1 character is present in that position.

Note "]C1" is a standard representation of the Function1 character on linear barcodes when read by scanning devices (including the NEOREADER app). For developers this does not mean the "]C1" is to be inserted in the barcode string. Depending on the library or technique being used, to achieve a Function1 character, you need to check the documentation or contact the providers of your barcode tool for advice.

Here are some examples of invalid 2D symbols when read by the NEOREADER app (note these issues are preventing barcodes from being recognised as Australia Post barcodes affecting processing and tracking as a result).

Check out what I just scanned with NeoReader:

"\$019931265099999891QCZ000000101000600200\$4202141\$8008170213053042"

Issue: Invalid Function1 character, there is a "\$" in the position of the Function1 characters

Check out what I just scanned with NeoReader:

"]d2019931265099999891336GN0001006010009302007420200208008170331090609"

Issue: characters are correct but located in the incorrect position. When acting as separator characters these should be before "420" and "8008" in the string below

Check out what I just scanned with NeoReader:

"_1019931265099999891KHH075306201000600207_14200851_18008170404163016"

Issue: An underscore followed by a 1 "_1" is not a valid FNC1 character

Check out what I just scanned with NeoReader:

"Jd20199312650999998917JHABCDEF0000159100093080242080092000000008008170328180613"

Two issues found:

- the article number is incorrect and the DPID is "00000000". If unknown, this value and its application identifier should be removed from the barcode string.
- Postcode is only 3 characters long and should be 4

Check out what I just scanned with NeoReader:

"Jd2019931265099999891JDQ77777902000931506420800817031 4000000"

Issue: Space in the date and time

Check out what I just scanned with NeoReader:

"019931265099999891M4M30000170100093150642042178008170308131228"

Issue: Incorrect value as FNC1 at start of the string should be "Jd2" instead.

Check out what I just scanned with NeoReader:

"019931265099999891THK10015280200093030142050618008170308155758"

Issue: No FNC1 characters at all

Check out what I just scanned with NeoReader:

"FNC1019931265099999891DJS123456701000600204FNC14203207FNC192FNC18008170303113922"

Issue: String "FNC1" in the position of a FNC1 character is not valid

Check out what I just scanned with NeoReader:

"Jd2019931265099999891JDQ03716790100060020942023228008170302144700"

Issue: Note two FNC1 characters before AI 8008 (If no DPID is available AI92 and its corresponding FNC1 character need to be removed.

Check out what I just scanned with NeoReader:

"019931265099999891JDQe42031499283279523e800820170216122430"

Issue: No FNC1 at the beginning of the string, also incorrect separator character

Regular Label quality checks

Figure 12: Quality checks to ensure labelling is correct on items.

1. Your label should be on matte white paper, with barcode and address printed clearly and visibly in black ink.

Ensure you're printing your label using black ink on matte white paper.



Check your printer heads are clean and the label is clearly visible. Print lines caused by dirty print heads can make barcodes unreadable.



Check the print quality is good – the ink should be black, not grey/faded.



2. Make sure your label is flat and free from damage, including wrinkles and wrapping.

The label should be flat and free from damage, including wrinkles and wrapping.



Check for damage - ensure your barcode isn't torn or ripped in anyway.



Check the label is not wrapped over an edge.



3. Include a Smart Barcode and a Delivery Point Identifier (DPID). (Australia Post Only)



Smart Barcodes hold all the data of a linear barcode with the option of also adding a Delivery Point Identifier (DPID). A DPID is a unique reference number for a specific physical delivery address. Including the DPID contributes to parcel delivery efficiencies.

For more information on label quality and Smart Barcodes, please speak to your Account Manager or Australia Post lodgement point.

Figure 13: Label Placement - This is critical to ensure address and barcodes are exposed to scanning devices during processing and delivery.

1. Label should be clearly visible, with no strapping or tape covering it.

Label should appear clearly on the item.



Check the label isn't obstructed by strapping. It should be clearly visible.



Avoid applying sticky tape over the label.



If reusing packaging, ensure all old labels and barcodes are either removed or not visible.



2. Place labels on the largest, flattest surface of your parcel or freight. Make sure it isn't wrapping around any edges, or positioned over a flap, fold or seam in your packaging.

Check the label is positioned on the parcels largest surface.



Check the label is visible on one side of the item only, and make sure it doesn't wrap around any edges.



Check the label is flat and avoid placing it over the packaging fold or flap.



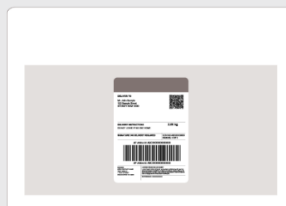
3. When using a plastic sleeve or letter window.

Make sure the plastic isn't too shiny. Reflective materials will make it harder for our equipment to read your label.



4. When using a satchel.

Place the label in the middle of the satchel, on the flattest surface.



Tracking Details

When generating labels in house, you are required to manage the allocation of tracking numbers to ensure they are not duplicated. This section shows where to include tracking_details in the payload (electronic data) and in which format.

The example on page 11 shows a typical “Create Shipment” JSON payload; however, it is also applicable to the “Create Order including Shipments” API Create Shipment Payload.

Where the `consignment_tracking_id` is the MLID followed by seven digits, the `article_tracking_id` is the consignment number followed by parcel count, product code, service code, postage paid indicator and check digit (see below in yellow)

The `article_barcode_data` is the representation of the 2D barcode string on the label and includes all components below:

- **019931265099999891**
A constant prefix that indicates the barcode is an Australia Post one (fixed value)
- **111JD**
Merchant Location ID (MLID)
- **0000120**
Consignment suffix (counter) ...from 0000001 to 9999999 per account before reusing numbers.
- **01**
Parcel count within the consignment (maximum count is 99 per consignment)
- **00121**
Product code (refer to page 6.)
- **09**
Two digits service code (refer to Product Attributes on page 6).
- **0**
Postage paid (fixed value)
- **5**
Check digit of the article id (resulted from check digit algorithm in page 22)

	Pipe character required in the electronic data to represent the position of a Function1 character acting as group separator character in the 2D barcode (physical label).
420	GS1 Application Identifier for domestic postcode (fixed value).
2000	Destination postcode.
	Pipe character required in the electronic data to represent the position of a Function1 character acting as group separator character in the 2D barcode (physical label).
8008	GS1 Application Identifier for date and time (fixed value).
200618120000	Date time of label generation (“YYMMDDhhmmss”).

Appendix

Glossary

Terms used throughout this document.

Term	Definition
Article	Item being sent by Sender/Merchant. Avoid: Item, object, parcel (and packaging type)
AMAS	Address Matching Approval Systems - An Australia Post certification program which measures the accuracy of address matching software The link below provides further information on the program and the list of approved matching software systems. https://auspost.com.au/business/marketing-and-communications/business-letter-services/barcoding-process/address-matching-approval-system-amas?fm=search-organic:amas:2
Consignment	A grouping of articles that have these common attributes: Same Speed Same Sending and Destination address (Referred to as Shipment)
Consignment Size	Dimensions (width, length and height) of each article in the consignment
Consignment Weight	Total sum of the Dead weight (Physical weight) of the articles being sent in the consignment.
Cubic factor	Value used to calculate Cubic weight
Cubic weight	Article's volume in cubic meters multiplied by cubic factor
DPID	Delivery Point Identifier, it is an eight digits number which relates to a geographical address, it is used by the sorting equipment during automated parcel processing.
GS1	Global Standards Organisation (formerly known as European Article Numbering Association or EAN) is a neutral, not-for-profit, international organization developing and maintaining standards including barcodes. As a member of GS1, Australia Post has adopted these standards which are broadly used in the Transport Industry.
Locality	Suburb or town within Postcode
MLID	Merchant Location Id – three of five alpha-numeric characters which represent a merchant account number. It is present in the consignment, article and barcodes to identify the sender.
Manifest	Source of data of the consignment and articles that we are collecting from a Sender on a particular day

Post Code	A numeric code that covers a group of localities All Postcodes in Australia are four digits
Satchel	Plastic 'bag' of a predetermined size. Biodegradable 'bag'
Streaming	Separated by product (also referred to as segregation) E.G. Small parcel vs large parcel Process: Stream then sort
Subsequent Parcel	Second (or more) article number in a consignment.

Document Version History

Version	Date	Change description
V1.0	29/05/2023	Approval to move from Draft to V1.0
V1.1	30/05/2023	Adjustment of content throughout entire document, such as spelling & grammar, updates to information in diagrams and tables etc.
V1.2	02/06/2023	New Postcode Ranges table (page 7).
V1.3	06/06/2023	'N-status' added to the Product Attributes (page 6).
V1.4	06/06/2023	Modified wording around 'Y-status' and 'N-status' in Product Attributes table (page 6).
V1.5	16/06/2023	- Grammatical correction (page 7). - Spelling correction (page 12). - Adjustments to Label Data Map (page 16). - Adjustments to GS1-128 component descriptions table (page 22) and GS1-Data Matrix component descriptions table (page 24).
V1.6	28/06/2023	- Added bullet point to explain that a separate manifest must be created separate from other services (page 8). - Added bullet point to explain the same MLID used to with Parcel Post and Express Post parcels can be used with Metro Service (Page 8). - Correction to "date" description in Label Data Map (page 16). - Added "Version History" to the end of documentation.
V1.7	11/08/2023	- Update to content under 'What is Metro?' subheading to include that there is no pricing available, and an error will be presented (pages 4 and 7). 'Zone' and 'Description' columns removed from table of postcode ranges not included (page 7). - Note added to explain that Metro shipments must be within the same city (i.e., MEL to MEL, SYD to SYD, BNE to BNE) (page 7). - New sub-section under JSON Payload Example includes the examples of error code due to invalid lodgement/destination postcode pairing (page 11). - Update to GS1 Data Matrix descriptions table to include previously missed information (page 25—26).

Version	Date	Change description
V1.8	16/08/2023	Updated QLD postcode ranges.
V1.9	20/05/2024	- Inclusion of Adelaide and Perth. - Postcode ranges: replaced table with attached spreadsheet, incl. access instructions (page 7). - Removed references for Packaging and Delivery features on pages 17 and 18.